Year 3 English | Plants in Every Classroom?

Learn and notice | Explain why a reason matters

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Name: _____ Date: _____

Learning intention

I can explain how a reason supports my opinion and add a relevant example.

Should Our Class Have a Herb Pot?

Our class should have a small herb pot if we can care for it properly. It would give us a living plant to observe closely.

Watching the same plant over time could help us notice changes. For example, we could draw its leaves each week and compare their size. This would give us observations to discuss in science lessons.

A care roster could also help us practise responsibility. Students could check the soil before deciding whether to water it, with adult guidance.

With a suitable spot and a care plan, a herb pot would be a useful addition to our classroom.

Writing detective

1. What condition does the writer include in the opening?
2. How does observing leaves support the learning reason?
3. How does the example support the responsibility reason?

Notice and explain

A. Plants are good because they are nice.
B. A class plant gives us something to observe because we can compare its leaves over time.
Which reason is explained more clearly? Why?

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Year 3 English | Plants in Every Classroom?

Think and plan | Explain why a reason matters

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Your writing task

Write to your teacher about plants in every classroom. State your view, explain a reason and illustrate it with an example. Add a second developed reason if you are ready. Group related ideas in paragraphs.

My position

Should every classroom have plants? You can agree, disagree or propose conditions.

Main reason

Choose a reason that matters to teachers or students.

Explain how or why

What would happen? Why would that support your view?

Matching example

Describe a particular classroom situation. Do not invent facts or statistics.

Ending

Return to your opinion. Include a practical condition if relevant.

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Write your draft | Use your own ideas

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Your turn

Write to your teacher about plants in every classroom. State your view, explain a reason and illustrate it with an example. Add a second developed reason if you are ready. Group related ideas in paragraphs.
Useful words: observe, compare, care, responsibility, suitable. Use words only when they fit.

My writing

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Edit and improve | Show what changed

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Read your draft aloud

[ ] I stated a clear position.
[ ] I explained how or why my reason matters.
[ ] My example supports that explanation.
[ ] My conclusion matches my position.

One focused improvement

Before: Plants help us learn.
After: A class plant could help us observe change because we could compare its new leaves with last week's drawing.
Choose a vague reason. Add how or why it matters and check that your example matches.

My before-and-after revision

Original sentence(s):

Improved version:

Explain your change

My change helps the reader because _____

Final writing detective check

[ ] I checked capitals, punctuation and spelling.
[ ] I grouped related ideas in paragraphs where useful.
[ ] I can explain one meaningful change.

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Year 3 English | Plants in Every Classroom?

Teacher and parent guide | Answers and teaching support

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Teaching sequence

Use two sessions: read/discuss/plan (about 20–25 minutes), then write/revise (about 20–30 minutes). Adjust to the learner. Rehearse orally before writing; supply extra paper if needed. Models are teaching examples, not scripts to memorise.

Answers and acceptable alternatives

The class must be able to care for it properly. Comparing leaves over time provides observations of change.
A roster and checking the soil give students a task and decision to manage with guidance.
Notice task: B explains a specific benefit and how it works. A uses vague praise without explaining a benefit.

Support, challenge and coaching

Support: Use a spoken chain: I think... because... This matters because... For example... . Allow a disagree position.
Challenge: Address a practical concern such as light, space or care, then suggest a realistic condition.
Ask: How would that happen? What example could help the reader understand?

Record learning and check transfer

For each page 4 skill, record Not yet / With support / Independently. Give one specific next step and let the child make the change. Record adult prompting or scribing.
Later prompt: Should Every Classroom Have a Weather Chart?. Hide the model and check whether the target skill transfers. These are classroom practice criteria, not NAPLAN scores.

Curriculum and preparation scope

Supports selected aspects of AC9E3LY06: planning, creating and editing writing, simple paragraphs and language control.
Guided skill practice for NAPLAN preparation; not an official test or score prediction.
Sources: ACARA v9 Year 3 “Narrative - Oceania”; nap.edu.au narrative and persuasive writing guides.

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